PP-F-00381K(Army-GL)
APRIL 7, 1977
Interim revision of
Fed. Spec. PP-F-381J
April 17, 1975

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FISH: CHILLED AND FROZEN

This interim Federal specification was developed by the US Army Natick Research and Development Command (GL), Natick, MA 01760 based on currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification PP-F-381J, dated April 17, 1975.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers fish, chilled and frozen, for use of all Federal agencies.

1.2 Classification. The product shall be of the following species, types, market forms, as specified (see 6.1 and appendix).

1.2.1 Types.

I - Chilled (not previously frozen)
II - Frozen

1.2.2 Market forms. The fish shall be furnished in the following market forms:

Form I - Whole or round (not dressed)
Form II - Dressed
Form III - Fillets

(a) Single

(a) Skin on
(b) Skinless

(2) Butterfly

Form IV - Steaks

FSC 8905

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1.2.3 Species. The species shall be as specified (see table I).

TABLE I. Finfish species

Common Name	Scientific Name
Barracuda	Syphyraena Argentea
Cabrilla, Spotted	Epinephelus Analogus
Cod, Pacific	Gadus Macrocephalus
Cod, Atlantic	Gadus Morhua
Flounder, Summer	Paralichthys Dentatus
Flounder, Arrowtooth	Atheresthes Stomias
Flounder, Witch	Glyptocephalus Cynoglossus
Flounder, Yellowtail	Limanda Ferruginea
Flounder, Winter	Pseudopleuronectes Americanus
Grouper, Nassau	Epinephelus Striatus
Grouper, Black	Mycteroperca Bonaci
Haddock	Melanogrammus Aeglefinus
Halibut, Pacific	Hippoglossus Stenolepis
Halibut, Atlantic	Hippoglossus Hippoghossus
Halibut, Greenland	Reinhardtius Hippoglossodes
Jewfish	Epinephelus Itajara
Lingcod	Ophiodon Elongatus
Mackerel, Atlantic	Scomber Scombrus
Mackerel, King	Scomberomorus Cavalla
Mackerel, Spanish	Scomberomorus Maculatus
Ocean Perch	Sebastes Marinus
Ocean Perch, Pacific	Sebastes Alutus
Pollock, Pacific	Pollachius Virens
Red Snapper	Lutjanus Campechanus
Rockfishes	Sebastes Species
Salmon, Chum	Oncorhynchus Keta
Salmon, Coho	Oncorhynchus Kistuch
Salmon, Sockeye	Oncorhynchus Nerka
Salmon, Chinook	Oncorhynchus Tshawytscha
Salmon, Atlantic	Salmo Salar
Salmon, Pink	Oncorhynchus Gorbuscha
Smelt, Rainbow	Osmerus Mordax
Smelt, Surf	Hypomesus Pretiosus
Smelt, (Eulachon)	Thaleichthys Pacificus
Sea bass, white	Cynoscion Nobilis
Sole, Rex	Glyptocephalus Zachirus
Sole, Dover	Microstomus Pacificus
Sole, English	Parophrys Vetulus
Whiting (Silver Hake)	Merluccius Bilinearis
Yellow Tail	Seriola Dorsalis

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

L-C-110	-	Cellophane (Coated and Noncoated Regenerated Cellulose Film)
L-P-378	-	Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin
UU-P-31	-	Paper; General Specifications and Methods of Testing
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-1163	-	Box, Corrugated Fiberboard, High Compression Strength, Weather-Resistant, Wax-Resin Impregnated

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-101	-	Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Materials: Test Procedures
FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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LAWS AND REGULATIONS

US DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE

US Standard for Grades Whole or Dressed Fish - Part 261
US Standard for Grades of Fish Steaks - Part 262
US Standard for Grades of Fish Fillets - Part 263

Regulations Governing Processed Fishery Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the US Department of Commerce, National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, National Marine Fisheries Service, Fishery Products Research and Inspection Division, Washington, DC 20240.)

US PUBLIC HEALTH SERVICE

Drinking Water Standards

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

US DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION AND WELFARE

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Docume US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20044.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

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UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for references from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The finished product shall be prepared from clean, wholesome fish of excellent quality and of the species specified. Only current or latest season's pack is acceptable. Spent salmon (Salmon after spawning) shall not be acceptable.

3.2 Processing. The fish product(s) shall be handled and processed in accordance with the applicable US Standard for Grades for the market form and species specified in the purchase document.

3.2.1 Chilled fish (type I). The fish shall be chilled to an internal temperature of 40°F (4°C) or less following processing and shall be maintained at such a temperature until delivery.

3.2.2 Frozen fish (type II). The fish shall be placed in a freezer maintained at 0°F (-18°C) or less within two hours from time of processing and frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F (-18°C) or less within 72 hours.

3.2.2.1 Forms I and II (whole and dressed fish). When specified (see 6.1) each fish shall bear a label placed on at time of initial freezing. The label shall bear the date of initial freezing and species nomenclature.

3.2.2.2 Form IV (steaks). Frozen fish to be steaked must be identified by the supplier in such a manner that the storage age of such fish can be ascertained. Steaks cut from frozen fish must be cut after the date of award of the contract. Steaks may be cut from fresh chilled fish.

3.2.3 Glazing. After freezing, forms I, II, and IV shall be glazed and placed in storage of 0°F (-18°C) or below.

3.3 Finished product. The finished product shall consist of chilled or frozen fish meeting the following requirements:

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a. Shall be US Grade A.

b. Weight shall be as follows for each market form or species as specified (see 6.1).

(1) Form I (Whole or round) - as specified

(2) Form II (Dressed) - as specified

(3) Form III (Fillets) - shall weigh not less than 3 ounces (85 g) nor more than 24 ounces (681 g), or as specified (see 6.1).

(4) Form IV (Steaks) - shall weigh not less than 3 ounces (85 g) nor more than 24 ounces (681 g), or as specified (see 6.1).

3.4 Frozen storage. Once the fish product is frozen, glazed (where applicable), and properly packed, it shall be stored frozen as follows: (In no case shall the product temperature of the frozen fish exceed 0°F (-18°C) prior to frozen storage).

(1) The temperature in the approximate center of the packed boxes shall not exceed 0°F (-18°C) during the period of storage and at time of shipment.

(2) The temperature within the freezer shall be maintained at 0°F (-18°C) or below. The freezer temperature may fluctuate (not to exceed 6°F (-14°C) for short periods to allow for entering the freezer to restock, withdraw, etc.

(3) The product shall be in excellent condition and the temperature in the approximate center of the packed boxes shall not exceed 0°F (-18°C) at time of acceptance by the Government at destination.

(4) The product shall show no evidence of thawing or refreezing when examined at time of acceptance by the Government.

3.4.1 Frozen storage time limits. The maximum storage limit for the frozen fish shall not be in excess of 180 days at the time of acceptance, calculated from the time the fish was initially frozen, with the following exceptions: Fillets of Pacific Ocean perch and bocaccio, 120 days; chillipepper, lobe-jawed rockfish, orange rockfish, red rockfish, and channel rockfish, 60 days; Atlantic Ocean Perch, 120 days. Storage time for halibut steaks shall be not in excess of 270 days, computed from time of initial freezing of the fish.

3.5 All provision not specifically contained herein shall comply with the Regulations Governing processed fishery products from code of Federal Regulations.

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3.6 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared in a type I official establishment under product inspection (contract basis) of the National Marine Fisheries Service, National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, US Department of Commerce (USDC).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements, specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Plant qualification conditions. The product furnished under this document shall be acceptable if not produced in plants which currently meet the qualification conditions of 3.6.

4.3 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with the Regulations Governing processed fishery products, code of Federal Regulations Title 50, Part 260.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.1 Examination of fish prior to processing. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with paragraph 3.1.

4.3.2 Processing examination. Examination shall be performed during processing to determine compliance with the requirements of paragraph 3.2.

4.3.3 Inspection of the finished product. Examination of the finished product shall be in accordance with paragraph 4.3.3.1 through 4.3.3.6.

4.3.3.1 Examination of end item. Examination of the finished product shall be made to determine compliance with US standards for grade A, whole or dressed fish; fish fillets; and fish steaks.

4.3.3.2 Examination of packaging. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with paragraph 5.1. The lot size and sample size shall be expressed as cartons. The defects shall be as listed in table II.

TABLE II. Examination of packaging

Defect
Forms I & II
Product not wrapped
Wrapping material not as specified
Product not individually or completely covered by wrapper

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TABLE II. Examination of packaging (cont'd)

Defect
Form III
Product not individually or completely wrapped
Wrapping material not as specified
Form IV
Product not individually or completely wrapped (when applicable)
Wrapping material not as specified
Carton not waxed or fiberboard box not lined as required (see 5.1.1.3)
Product not arranged in layers or the thickness of a layer exceeds one steak (when applicable)
Wrapper or bag not closed as specified
Top layer not covered or cover not made of proper material (when applicable)
Net weight of filled package 1/
(Package one pound ((.45 kg)) or less). Net weight more than five percent under specified weight
(Package more than one pound ((.45 kg)) but not more than ten pounds ((4.5 kg)). Net weight more than two percent under specified weight
(Package more than ten pounds ((4.5 kg)). Net weight more than one percent under specified weight

1/ To determine amount of glaze, when applicable, see 4.3.3.3.1.

4.3.3.3 Examination for net weight of glazed items. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with net weight of glazed items. The lot size and sample size shall be expressed in shipping container (boxes). Sample unit shall be a filled shipping container. The lot shall be non-conforming if the sample average net weight is determined to be less than the sample average marked net weight.

4.3.3.3.1 The procedure for determining the amount of glaze per shipping container shall be in accordance with method 18.001 of the AOAC.

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4.3.3.4 Examination for frozen storage limits. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with 3.4. Storage temperature and age requirements shall be ascertained by examination of labels, invoices, marking, storage records or other valid means or documentation.

4.3.3.5 Examination for labeling and marking (levels C and B). Examination shall be made to determine compliance with 5.3. The lot size and sample size shall be expressed as cases. The defects shall be as listed in table III.

TABLE III. Examination of marking, labeling and net weight

Defects
Marking, missing, incorrect or illegible.
Net weight exceeds fifty pounds or less than marked net weight.

4.3.3.6 Examination of shipping containers (level B - Export). Examination shall be made to determine compliance with paragraph 5.2.1. The lot size and sample size shall be expressed as cases. The defects shall be as listed in table IV.

TABLE IV. Examination of packing 1/ (Level-B Only)

Defect
Closure, top and bottom flaps glued 2/
Not glued
Less than 50 percent failure of surface area covered by glue
Less than 75 percent but more than 50 percent fiber failure of the surface area covered by glue
Tape
Not size, style or type specified
Not reinforced as specified
Strapping
Strap missing
Not properly placed or not applied correctly
Not applied at right angles to edges resulting in looseness
Torn strap
Loose strap
Cut strap
Weak joint
Tension too great, that is, tears or cuts completely through board facing

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TABLE IV. Examination of packing 1/ (Level-B Only) (cont'd)

Defect
Container (Case)
Product not packed to produce a snug fitting container
Type of fiberboard not as specified 3/
Tear or hole
Unclean
Not packed as specified
Not closed as specified
Not reinforced as specified

1/ For requirements see Appendix to PPP-B-636.

2/ Inspector shall check for glue failure in the following manner: Draw samples of sealed cases and tear flaps apart by wedging fingers between flaps, in center of cases and pulling upward. If failures occur and glue still is tacky, repeat test allowing a greater time interval between sealing and testing.

3/ As indicated by box maker's stamp.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation-packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1 or 5.1.2, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level B.

5.1.1.1 Forms I and II. The frozen and glazed product shall be individually and completely wrapped in cellophane, wax paper, polyethylene, biaxially oriented polypropylene, or rubber hydrochloride-base-plastic film of good quality commercial materials normally used in packaging frozen foods.

5.1.1.2 Form III. Fillets packaged in 1, 2-1/2, 5 or 10 pound units shall be completely wrapped in cellophane, wax paper, polyethylene, biaxially oriented polypropylene, or rubber hydrochloride-base-plastic film of good quality commercial materials normally used in packaging frozen foods. Five to ten pounds of the wrapped product shall be packaged in a paperboard carton. The carton shall be fabricated from bleached, semi-bleached, sulphate, sulphite or solid kraft paperboard, cold waxed or polyethylene coated overall. Alternatively, the carton shall be coated on the inside with polyethylene and on the outside with a food grade varnish. Glazing is not acceptable.

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5.1.1.3 Form IV. Fish steaks shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1.3.1 or 5.1.1.3.2 as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1.3.1 Cartons. Five to ten pounds of the product shall be layer packaged in cartons. Each layer shall be separated by cellophane, wax paper, polyethylene, biaxially oriented polypropylene, or rubber hydrochloride-base-plastic film of good quality commercial material. Alternatively, if the steaks are individually wrapped in one of the materials specified above the layers need not be separated.

5.1.1.3.2 Bulk. The product shall be packed directly into shipping containers as specified in 5.2.1.1. The shipping containers shall be waxed paper lined in accordance with 5.2.1.1.a. The steaks shall be arranged in layers with each layer separated by cellophane, waxed paper, polyethylene, biaxially oriented polypropylene, or rubber hydrochloride-base-plastic film of food quality commercial materials normally used in packaging frozen foods. In addition, a separator as described above shall be placed on the surface of the top layer. If the steaks are individually wrapped in one of the materials specified above the shipping containers may be lined in accordance with 5.2.1.1.a or 5.2.1.1.b and the layers need not be separated.

5.1.2 Level C. Unless otherwise specified commercial packaging is acceptable.

5.2 Packing. Not more than 50 pounds of fish shall be packed in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level B packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1.1 or 5.2.1.2, as applicable.

5.2.1.1 All forms, packages, other than cartons. The shipping container shall be constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style FTC, V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a snug fitting wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, Class 1, SWCFI, Grade 275 of PPP-B-1163. Closure shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax-impregnated box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Unless the product is packaged and sealed to prevent leakage, the interior surfaces of the style FTC box shall be protected by one of the following methods:

a. Completely lined inside with two sheets of waxed paper so placed as to separate the fish from the top, bottom, sides and ends of the shipping container. Each sheet shall be cut at least two inches wider than the surfaces to be protected and shall overlap at least 4 inches along the center at the top. One sheet shall be positioned over the top, sides, and bottom, and the other sheet shall be positioned over the top, ends, and bottom.

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b. Hot waxed overall in the inside with a fully refined paraffin wax having an average melting point of 125°F (52°C) when tested in accordance with method 4017 of FED-STD-101. The quantity of wax applied to the fiberboard shall be sufficient to show the presence of wax on the fingernail when it has been scraped lightly over the fiberboard.

c. Hot coated with polyethylene having a minimum thickness of 0.0005 inch.

5.2.1.1.1 Alternate shipping container No. 1. When specified (see 6.1 and 6.4) the shipping container shall be constructed and reinforced in accordance with style FTC, W5c, or W5s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a snugfitting, wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, Class I, type SWCFI, grade 200, of PPP-B-1163. Closure shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax-impregnated box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The interior of the shipping container shall be protected as specified in 5.2.1.1.

5.2.1.2 Forms III and IV in cartons. The shipping container shall be a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with Style RSC, V3c, V3s, V4s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a snug-fitting, wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, type SWCFI, grade 275 of PPP-B-1163. Closure shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax-impregnated box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.2.1 Alternate shipping container No. 2. When specified (see 6.1 and 6.4) the shipping container shall be a snugfitting fiberboard box constructed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, W5s, of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a snugfitting, wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with the style RSC, class I, type SWCFI, grade 200 of PPP-B-1163. Closure shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax impregnated box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.3 Nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping containers. When specified (see 6.1), the shipping container specified in 5.2.1.1 and 5.2.1.2 shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level C. The shipping container shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable. All slotted style shipping containers shall be securely closed by stapling or gluing.

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5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1.1 Unit containers. Any commercial labeling or additional labeling as specified, that complied with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder will be acceptable under this specification.

5.3.1.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with DPSC Form 3556.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) When freezing date label is required (see 3.2.2.1).
(c) Weights required for forms I, II, III and IV product (see 3.3).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) When packaging and packing specified in 5.1.1.3.1, 5.1.1.3.2, 5.2.1.1.1, 5.2.1.2.1 or 5.2.1.3 is required.

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, storage, and handling of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer shall select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/ NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.14D/DSAR 4145.7.

6.3 Intended use of nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping containers. Packing specified in 5.2.1.3 intended for transfer at sea operations or specific oversea operations.

6.4 Packing specified in 5.2.1.1.1 or 5.2.1.2.1 should be used when experience or knowledge of the destination or the mode of shipment would indicate that a lower grade of fiberboard can be used.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8905-A863

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